IPL Auction Valuation & Player Performance Intelligence: Data Kit

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Project overview

Business question: which IPL franchises get the most on-field value per crore spent at auction, and which players are over- or underpaid?

Deliverable	Tool	What it does
Analytics dashboard	Power BI	Joins auction prices with ball-by-ball performance to show runs, wickets and impact per crore by player, team and season
Auction app	MERN + MongoDB	Stores match data as JSON documents and lets users build a squad under a budget cap, scored on value for money

All data below is free and public. Download links are in the next section.

Core datasets

Download these three first. Everything else is optional.

Role	Dataset	Coverage	Format	Notes
Auction prices (main)	IPL Auction Dataset (2013-2026)	2013 to 2026	One CSV per auction year	Merge the yearly files into one table
Auction prices (backup)	IPL Player Auction Dataset, From Start to Now	2013 to 2022	Single CSV	Has player type, team, year, Indian vs overseas flag; CC0 licence

Role	Dataset	Coverage	Format	Notes
Performance (easiest)	IPL Ball By Ball Dataset (2008-2026)	2008 to 2026	One flat CSV, one row per ball	Match info (venue, season, toss, winner) already on every row; best for Power BI
Performance (alternative)	IPL Complete Dataset (2008-2024)	2008 to 2024	matches.csv + deliveries.csv	About 261k balls and 1,095 matches; clean star schema
Raw match data	Cricsheet	2008 to present	One JSON file per match	Deeply nested JSON; import each match as one MongoDB document

To get the Cricsheet IPL files: open cricsheet.org, go to the match downloads, and pick Indian Premier League in JSON format. Kaggle needs a free login to download.

Name matching (the hardest step)

Auction files say "Virat Kohli" while ball-by-ball files say "V Kohli". The Cricsheet Register fixes this.

- **people.csv**: one row per player, with a Cricsheet ID, their name, the exact name used in match files, and IDs from other cricket sites.
- **names.csv**: alternate and variant spellings for the same people.

Plan: map every auction name to a Cricsheet ID once, save it as a lookup table, and use that ID as the join key in both projects. Expect to fix a few dozen names by hand.

Optional extras

Dataset	What it adds	Use it for
Tata IPL Auction 2013-2024 (team purses)	Each team's funds left, overseas count and squad size after every auction	A franchise spending strategy page

Dataset	What it adds	Use it for
TATA IPL Auction List 2025	Age, country, Test/ODI/T20 caps, previous IPL teams, reserve price	Age vs price and experience vs price analysis
Official BCCI 2025 auction list (PDF)	The original source list with DOB, caps, reserve price and RTM flags	Verifying or filling gaps in Kaggle data
IPL 2025 auction announcement	Official counts: 574 players, 204 slots, reserve price brackets	Context slide numbers
IPL 2026 squads after the mini auction (Wisden)	Full squads for all 10 teams, new signings marked	Latest season squads
IPL 2026 unsold players (Wisden)	Unsold players with base price and set	An "unsold stars" insight

Which data goes where

Data	Power BI project	MERN + MongoDB project
Performance	lyc0riz or patrickb1912 CSVs	Cricsheet raw JSON, one match = one document in a `matches` collection
Auction prices	sunnyyadav754 yearly CSVs, appended into one table	`players` collection with an embedded `auctions[]` array (year, team, base price, sold price)
Join key	Cricsheet Register name lookup table	Cricsheet ID stored on each player document
Team purses (optional)	Team spend table	`franchises` collection

Why MongoDB fits: Cricsheet match files are nested JSON, and a player's auction history is a variable-length list. Both store naturally as documents without flattening.

Gotchas to plan for

1. **Analysis window:** auction prices start in 2013, so value-for-money analysis runs 2013 onward even though match data starts in 2008.
2. **Retained players:** often missing from auction files or listed without a fresh price. Decide early: exclude them, or use their retention price from news sources.
3. **Season alignment:** auctions happen the December before a season. The IPL 2026 auction was held in Abu Dhabi on 16 December 2025. Map each auction to the season it was for.
4. **Team renames:** merge old and new names before grouping, for example Delhi Daredevils to Delhi Capitals, Kings XI Punjab to Punjab Kings, and Royal Challengers Bangalore to Royal Challengers Bengaluru.
5. **Units:** some files list prices in lakhs, others in crores or plain rupees. Convert everything to crores first.

References and presentation hook

Reference projects (for structure, not copying):

- arka562/ipl_analysis: parses Cricsheet JSON into CSVs and builds a multi-page dashboard. Useful for the parsing step.
- Sahilzayn/IPL-Player-Auction-: auction price analysis with a prediction model.
- avinashyadav16/ipl-analytics: exploratory analysis on the 2008-2024 matches and deliveries files.

Opening slide idea: at the IPL 2026 auction, KKR paid Rs 25.20 crore for Cameron Green, the costliest overseas player and all-rounder ever bought at an IPL auction (Sakshi Post). Ask the room: was he worth it? The dashboard answers.